

BlenderShelf

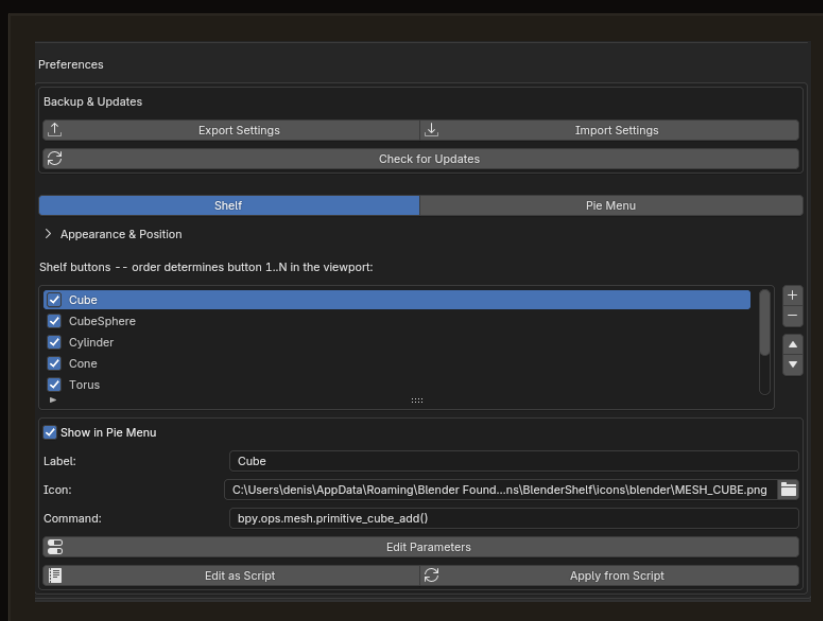
Quick user guide



What it is

A floating panel of buttons over the 3D viewport, Maya-shelf style, plus a radial pie menu on a hotkey. Each button runs its own Python code on click.

Preferences: tabs and the button list



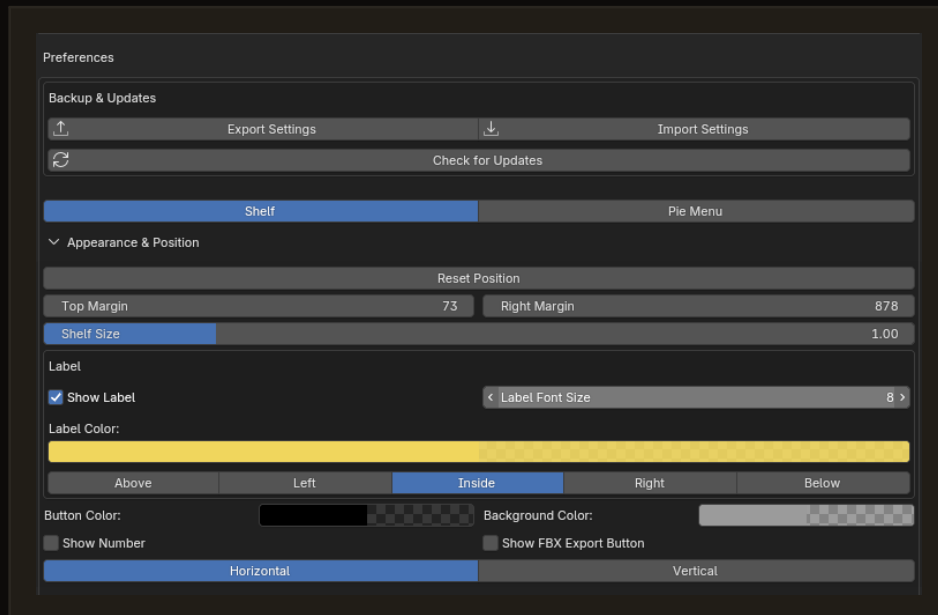
Backup & Updates, the Shelf/Pie Menu tabs, and the button list

In Preferences → Add-ons → BlenderShelf, the top holds a "Backup & Updates" box: Export/Import Settings save and load every addon setting as one JSON file, and "Check for Updates" checks the website for a newer release and, if one exists, offers a download link.

Below it are two tabs, "Shelf" and "Pie Menu" — only one page shows at a time, the same pattern many other addons use. The Shelf tab holds the shelf's appearance settings and its button list; the list's order sets the buttons' order in the viewport.

Every button has its own card: label, icon, command, "Edit Parameters", "Edit as Script" / "Apply from Script", and "Copy To..." — each covered in more detail below.

Shelf appearance and position

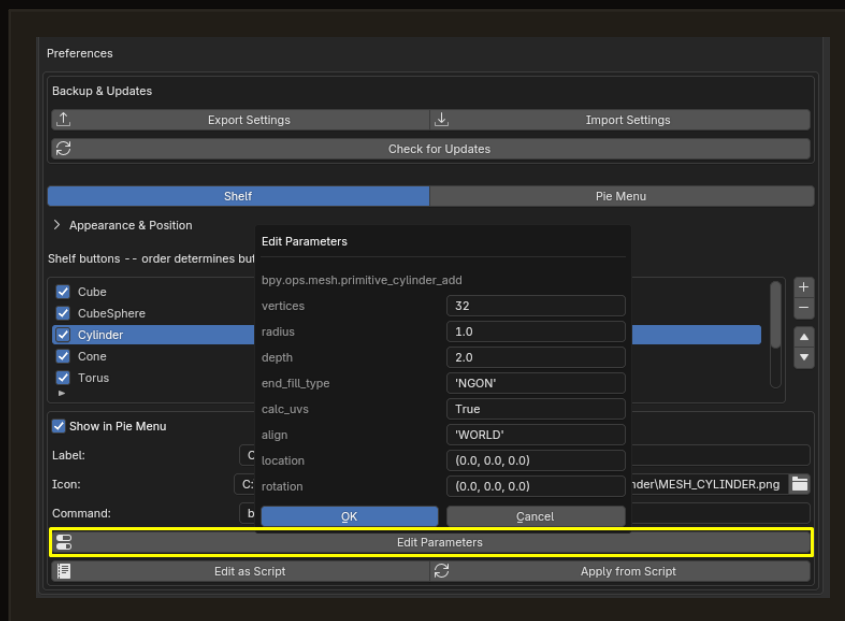


Appearance & Position: position, size, labels, colors

Inside the Shelf tab, a collapsible "Appearance & Position" panel holds a "Reset Position" button that returns the shelf to its default top-center spot, plus exact Top/Right Margin fields and a button-size slider.

The Label block controls the caption (shown or not, font size, color, placement relative to the button); below it are button/background color, number display, the FBX export button toggle (off by default on fresh installs), and the shelf's orientation.

Adjusting parameters without Python

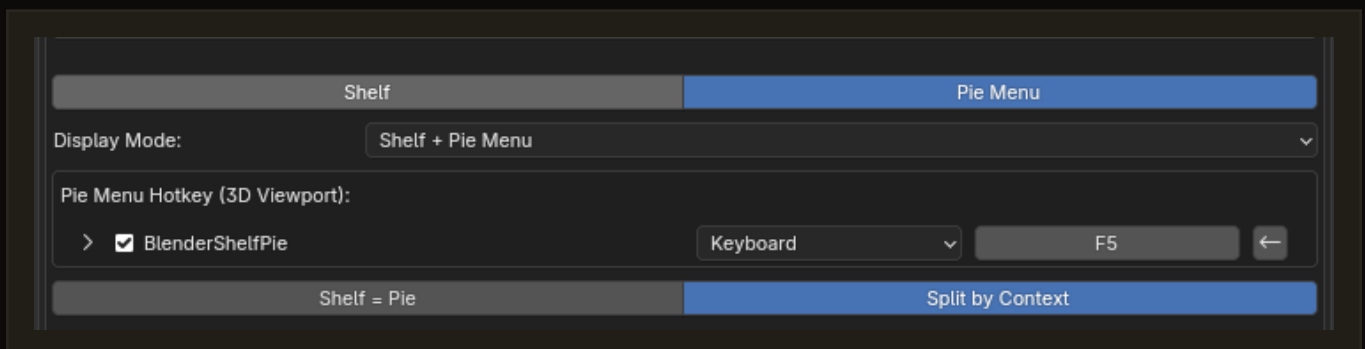


Edit Parameters: adjusting a cylinder's parameters without Python

"Edit Parameters" opens a window with a field for every named argument of the command — a cylinder's vertex count, radius, and depth, for instance — with no need to write or edit Python by hand.

Blender doesn't show its usual "Adjust Last Operation" panel for shelf or pie buttons: the command runs as code, not as a genuine click on a menu item, so Blender never links that call to its operator history. "Edit Parameters" is a workaround for the same job — when a parameter isn't written explicitly in the command, its value comes from the operator's own default, so the fields show up even for a command with no arguments at all.

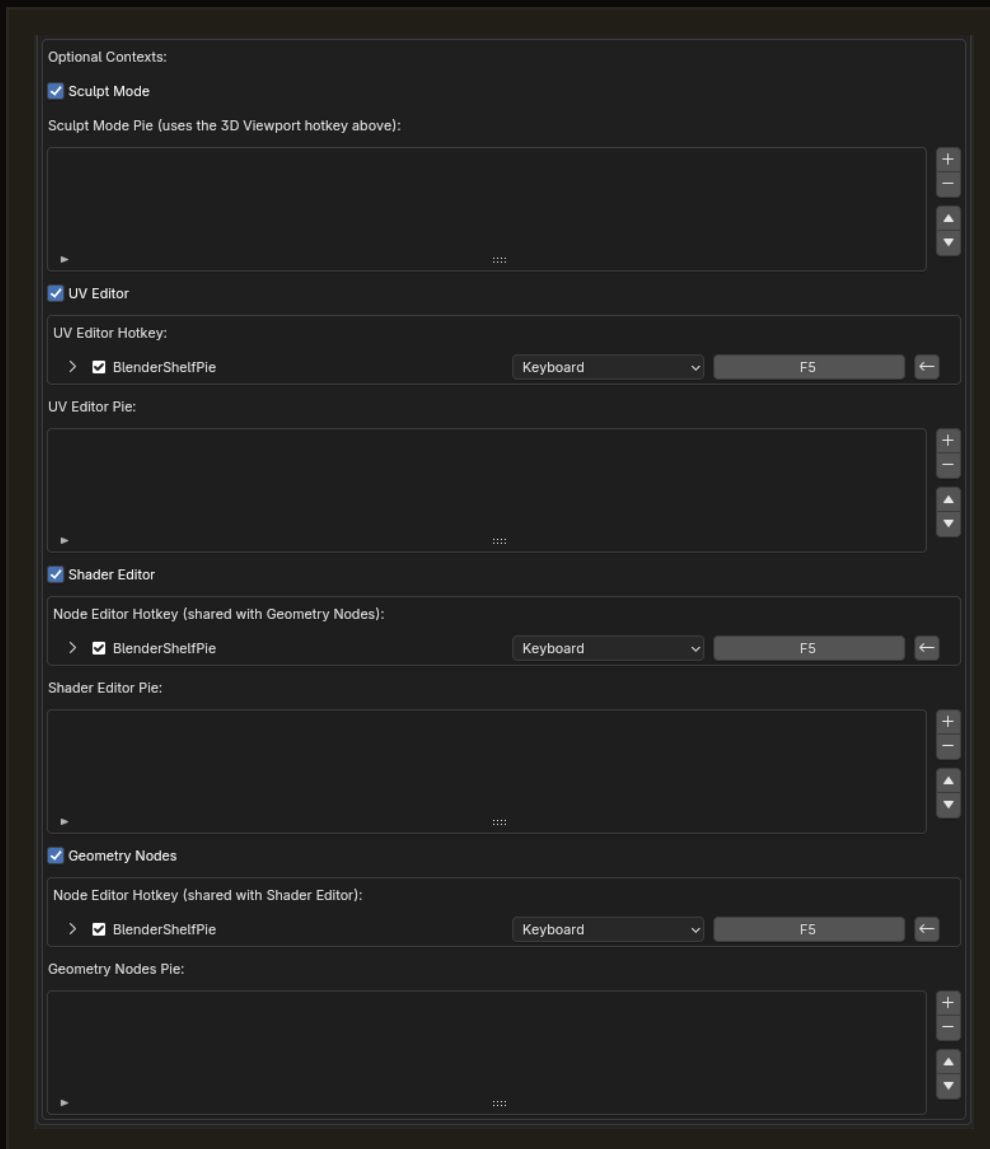
Pie menu: Shelf = Pie or Split by Context



Display Mode, the hotkey, and the Shelf = Pie / Split by Context switch

The Pie Menu tab holds the display mode, the hotkey, and how the pie menu itself is built. "Shelf = Pie" always mirrors the shelf's buttons. "Split by Context" builds independent pie menus for Object Mode and Edit Mode, each with its own button list.

Optional contexts

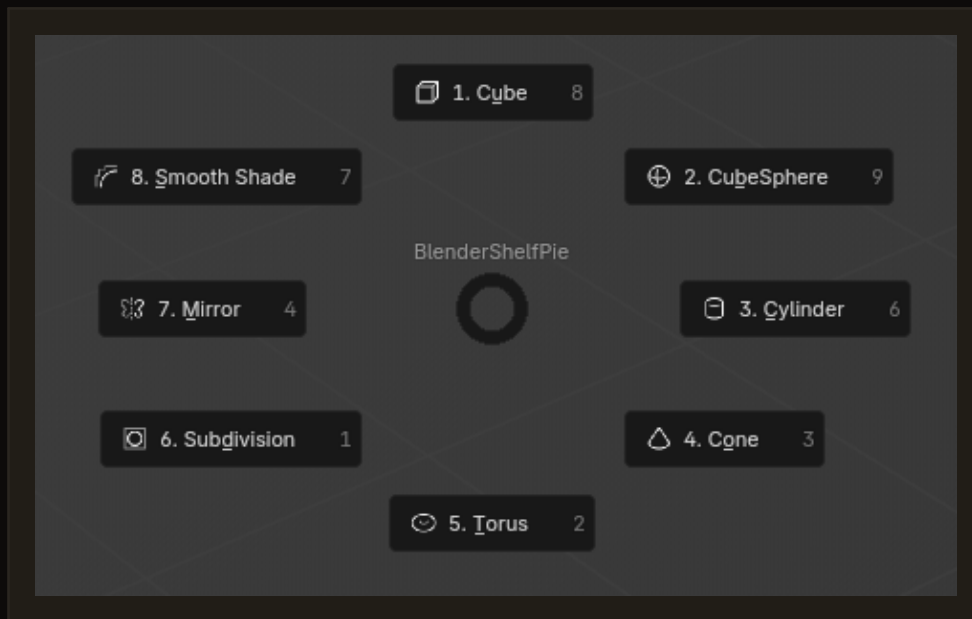


Optional Contexts: Sculpt Mode, UV Editor, Shader Editor, Geometry Nodes

In Split mode, an "Optional Contexts" block opens below with four more independent pie menus, each behind its own checkbox: Sculpt Mode, UV Editor, Shader Editor, Geometry Nodes. Enabled contexts float to the top of the list, disabled ones sink to the bottom.

Shader Editor and Geometry Nodes share one hotkey (the same Node Editor) but keep fully independent button lists — shading node groups never mix with geometry nodes. UV Editor and Node Editor register their own hotkey separately from the 3D viewport's.

The pie menu in the viewport



BlenderShelf's pie menu in Split mode (Object Mode)

The hotkey opens the radial menu. In Split mode, it shows only the current context's list (whichever object mode or editor is under the cursor), not everything at once — a button's number always matches its position in the matching settings list.

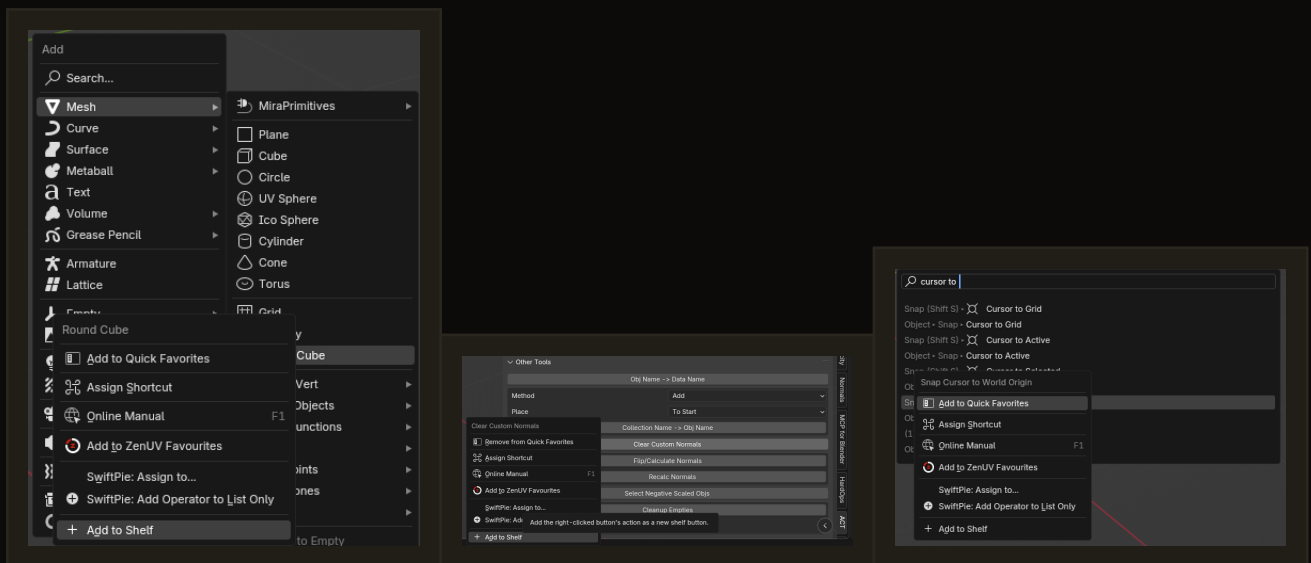
Orientation and moving the shelf



The ">" toggle and drag handle to the left of the panel

To the left of the panel: ">" toggles horizontal/vertical, and the three-dot handle drags with the mouse. Position is saved automatically.

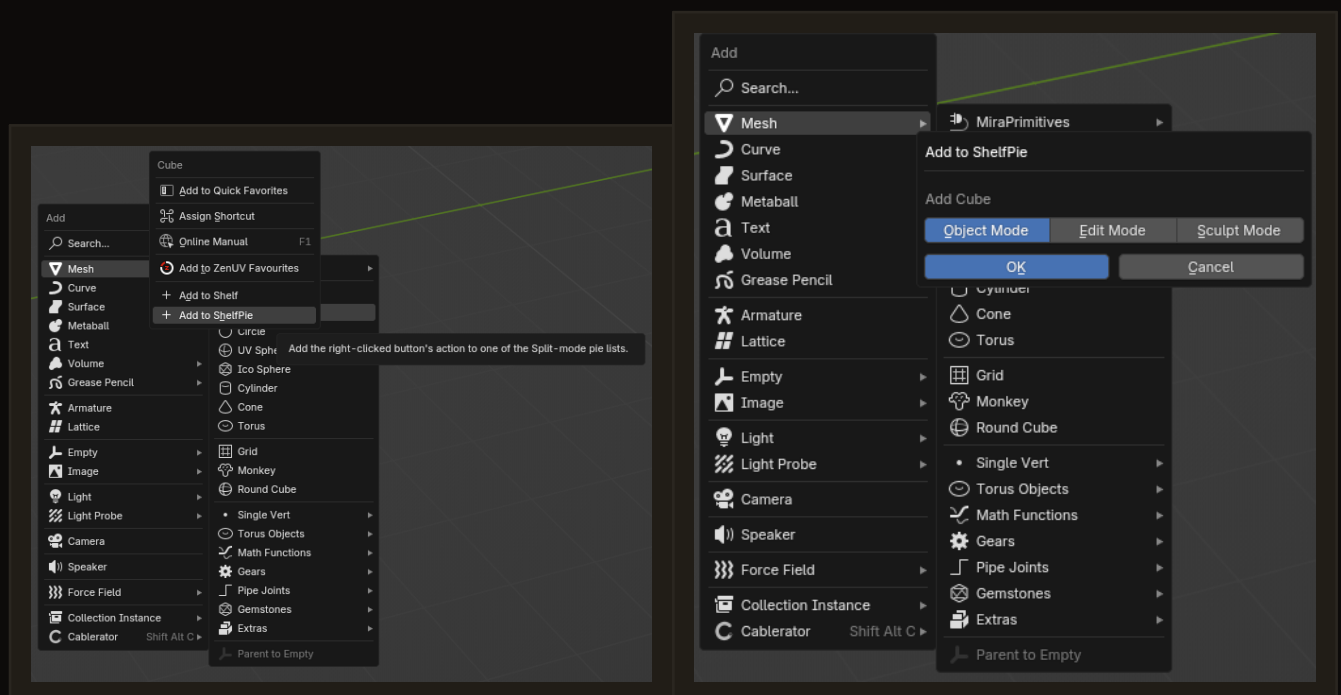
Three ways to add a button to the shelf



"Add to Shelf" works from any button's right-click menu: a built-in operator, a third-party addon's button, or a search (F3) result

1. "+" in the settings list — a blank slot; type in the command and label yourself.
2. Right-click any interface button, including third-party addons → "Add to Shelf".
3. Find the function via the operator search (F3), then the same way — right-click → "Add to Shelf".

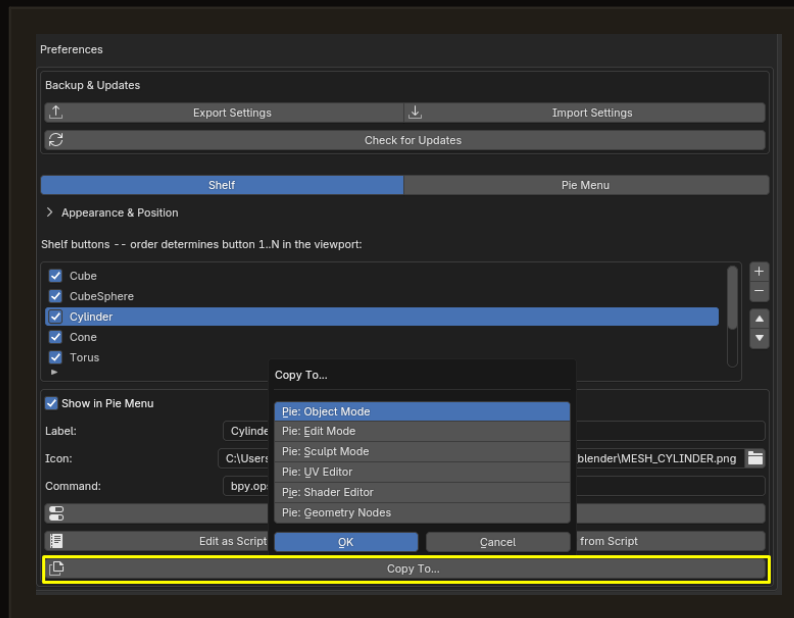
Adding straight to the pie menu



"Add to ShelfPie" in the right-click menu, and the category-picker dialog

In Split mode, "Add to ShelfPie" appears next to "Add to Shelf" in the same right-click menu — the same right-click capture, but with a dialog to pick a category (Object Mode, Edit Mode, and any enabled Optional Contexts). The dialog pre-selects the category that fits the current context.

Copying a button between lists



"Copy To...": the list is filtered to the enabled pie lists

The "Copy To..." button on every button's card places an independent copy of it into another list — from the shelf into the Edit Mode pie, for instance. Editing the command in one list never touches the copy in the other.

The list of available destinations adjusts itself: it only shows pie contexts that are actually enabled, and never offers to copy a button into itself. It's only available in Split mode — with Shelf = Pie there's nowhere to copy into, since the pie already mirrors the shelf.

What to put in Command

You can add your own script or macro (a sequence of commands), written yourself or by asking an AI (Claude, ChatGPT, and the like). For a quick tweak to a single operator call's parameters, "Edit Parameters" is easier — no need to edit Python by hand.